

Job Market Package

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1 Introduction

This file has different documents required to the job market. In a job market with foccus in academia, here is a check list of what you may need:

- Letter Writers
- Fields of Expertise
- Website
- Job Market Paper
- Research Statement
- Teaching Statement

2 Letter Writers

Usually you need three letter writers. One of them should be your primary advisor. The other two could be academic people who know your work as a researcher or as a teacher/teacher assistant. Usually, the other two are committee members.

It is important to share your papers, research, and teaching statements with the three letter writers before asking them to write a letter.

My three letter writers will be:

- Daniel Millimet
- Nathaniel Pattison
- Wookun Kim

3 Fields of Expertise

Choose up to three fields—for example, macro, trade, labor, health, etc. Preferably, choose fields that map to JEL codes. For better or worse, institutions like to label candidates. You need to justify to them that you fit the description. You can also emphasize your methodological expertise. Applied approach, quantitative approach, etc. Do this on your website and in your CV. It will be evident if they look at your paper

The first one will be your primary field. In my case, the big field that I fit is labor and demographic economics, which is coded with JEL *J*. My researchs involve demographic and labor, as I use (i) childcare (proxied by pre-K) in my first paper as a mediating channel in the path from low birthweight to education, (ii) explore the effects of robots' exposure (labor demand shock) on high school choices (human capital, acquisition of skills, etc), and (iii) I explore the effect of a technological change in parental time allocation to childcare.

First paper fits at J13, second paper fits at J13, J23, and J24, while last paper (JMP) fits J13 and D13, where:

- J13: Fertility; Family Planning; Child Care; Children; Youth
- J23: Labor Demand
- J24: Human Capital; Skills; Occupational Choice; Labor Productivity
- D13: Household Production and Intrahousehold Allocation ¹

Since the intersection of the three papers is given by J13, this should be my primary field.

4 Website

Links to your CV, JMP, and other papers. Brief description of your research interests and main fields. Make everything easily accessible on the home page. It is okay to have more pages if you want to elaborate on each paper. If you have a publication or R&R, make that stand out!

5 Job Market Paper

The job market paper should be your best work. According to the SMU Director of the Economics Department, it can be coauthored, preferably with no senior coauthors. Ask about what paper your advisor recommends. Include a hyperlink on the title page to the latest version. Try to constantly update the paper.

¹D belongs to Microeconomics general category.

6 Research Statement

The research statement is a description of your existing research and ideas for future research. High-level summaries, not as technical as an abstract. Therefore, try to draw connections between different papers. This statement is how you position yourself as an expert in a topic or methodology.

7 Teaching Statement

In the teaching statement, you will describe courses you have taught or TA'd for. Report statistics on course evaluations (if available). If you are applying to a Liberal Arts College, go more into teaching philosophy.

8 Timeline

- July-September
 - Letter writers, website, research and teaching statements.
- September-November
 - Start applying for jobs.
 - Template cover letters: one for academic jobs, one for private sector jobs.
 - Mock interviews/practice job talks in brown bag.
- December-January
 - Real interviews.
- January-March
 - Flyouts.
- April and beyond
 - More Job Postings: Academic Scramble, Visiting Positions, Post-Docs, Private Sector.

9 Where to Look for Jobs

- American Economic Association, Job Openings for Economists “the JOE”
- LinkedIn
- Contact SMU alumni
- Network at conferences (e.g., SEA)

- Let your advisor know your preferences: Academic/Policy/Private; Locational preferences